

# Quillforge

Forge your Markdown. See it like GitHub.

User Manual · v1.0.0

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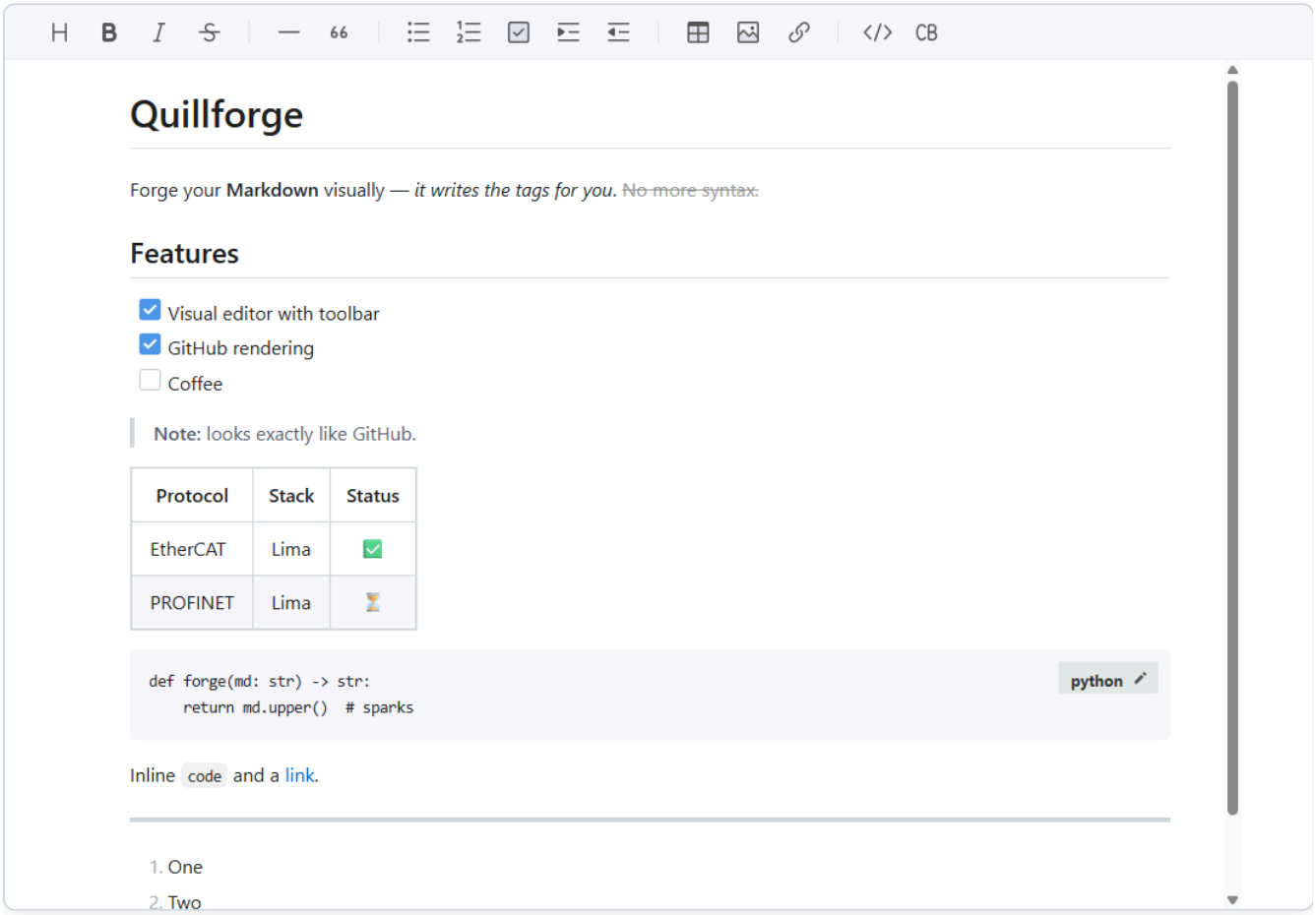
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# 1. What is Quillforge

**Quillforge** is a Markdown viewer and editor for Windows. You format text with buttons — headings, bold, lists, tables, code — and Quillforge writes the Markdown tags behind the scenes. Every document is shown exactly the way GitHub displays it, in light or dark theme.

It is designed for `README.md` files, notes, documentation and any `.md` file you want to read or edit without memorising syntax.




Visual editor: format with the toolbar, no tags in sight.

## 2. Installation

Run `Quillforge-Setup-1.0.0.exe`. The installer is available in English and Spanish and does **not** need administrator rights: it installs for the current user in `%LOCALAPPDATA%\Programs\Quillforge`.

| Option | What it does |
|---|---|
| Desktop shortcut | Adds a Quillforge icon to the desktop. |
| Open .md files with Quillforge | Adds Quillforge to *Open with* for .md / .markdown files, and makes it the handler for those files for the current user. |

Requirements: Windows 10 or 11 (64-bit) and Microsoft Edge WebView2 Runtime, which is already part of Windows 11. The .NET runtime is included; nothing else has to be installed.

To uninstall: *Settings → Apps → Installed apps → Quillforge → Uninstall*. Your settings in `%APPDATA%\Quillforge` are kept.

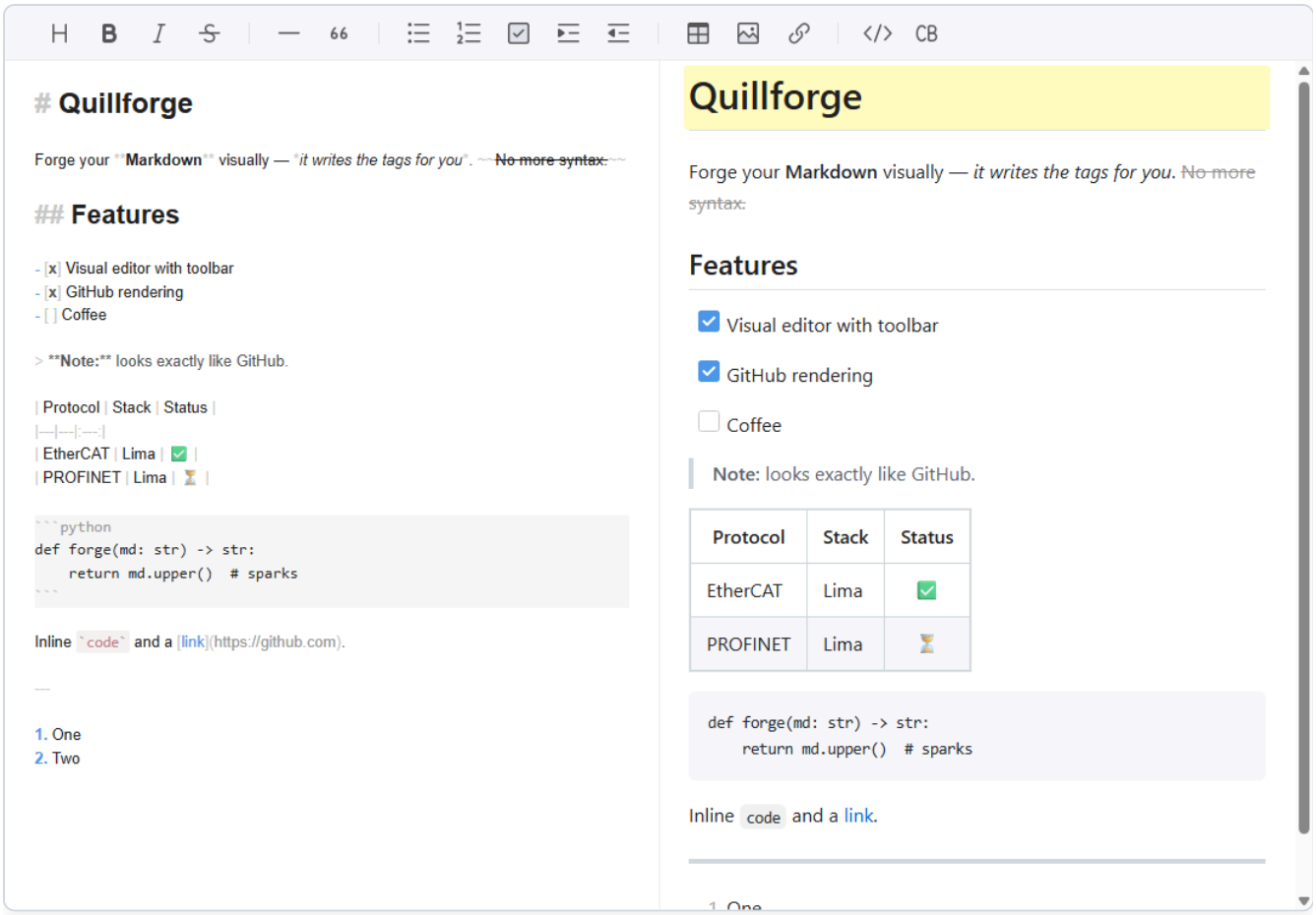
## 3. The window

| Part | Use |
|---|---|
| Menu bar | File, Edit, Format, View, Language and Help. All menus are available in English and Spanish. |
| Toolbar | The formatting buttons (see below). Hidden in GitHub preview, which is read-only. |
| Document | The page itself, laid out with the same column width, fonts and spacing as github.com. |
| Status bar | File path, word count, current mode, and whether there are unsaved changes. |

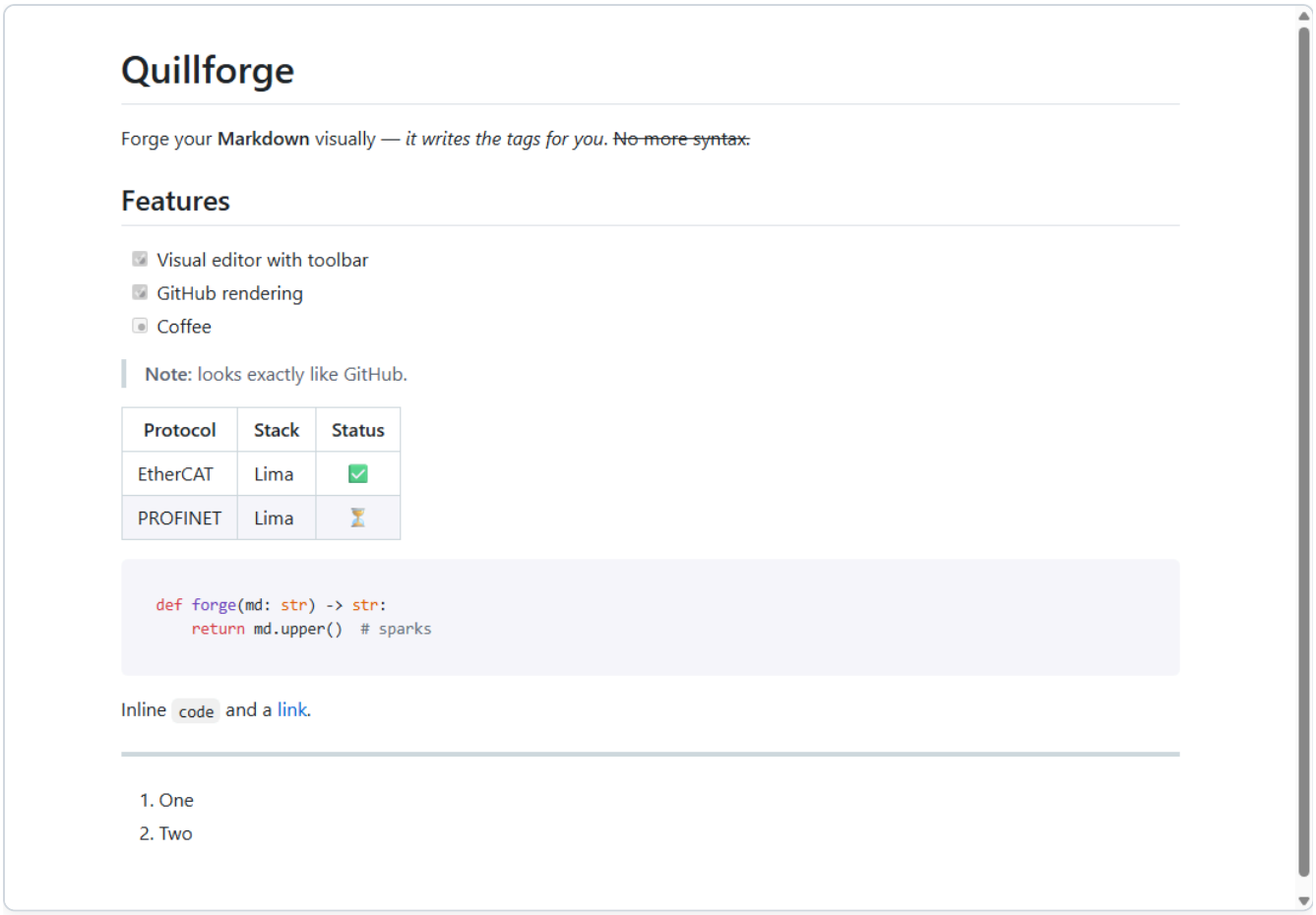
The title bar shows the file name; a ● in front of it means there are unsaved changes.

## 4. Three ways to see a document

| Mode | Shortcut | What you see |
|---|---|---|
| **Visual editor** | `Ctrl` + `1` | The formatted document. Type and use the buttons; the Markdown is generated for you. |
| **Markdown source** | `Ctrl` + `2` | The raw Markdown on the left and a live preview on the right. For when you want to see or touch the tags. |
| **GitHub preview** | `Ctrl` + `3` | Read-only page rendered like GitHub, with syntax highlighting, task lists and clickable links. |




Markdown source with live preview.




GitHub preview (light theme).

## 5. Formatting toolbar

| Button | Action | Markdown it writes |
|---|---|---|
| H | Heading 1–6 or normal paragraph | `# Title` … `###### Title` |
| **B** | Bold | `**text**` |
| *I* | Italic | `*text*` |
| ~~S~~ | Strikethrough | `~~text~~` |
| — | Horizontal rule | `***` |
| ❝ | Quote | `> text` |
| • list / 1. list | Bulleted / numbered list | `- item` / `1. item` |
| ☑ | Task list | `- [ ] task` |
| → / ← | Indent / outdent list item | nested list |
| Table | Insert table (choose rows × columns) | `\| a \| b \|` |
| Image | Insert image from URL or file name | `![alt](file.png)` |
| Link | Insert link | `[text](https://…)` |
| </> | Inline code | `` `code` `` |
| CB | Code block (choose language for colouring) | ` ```python ` |

The same actions are in the **Format** menu. Right-click inside a table to add or delete rows and columns, or to align a column.

## 6. Files

| Action | How |
|---|---|
| Open | *File* → *Open* (`Ctrl`+`O`), double-click a .md file, or drag a file onto the window. |
| Recent files | *File* → *Open recent* keeps the last 12 files. |
| Save / Save as | `Ctrl`+`S` / `Ctrl`+`Shift`+`S`. Files are saved as UTF-8 without BOM, the same as GitHub. |
| New / New window | `Ctrl`+`N` starts an empty document; *New window* opens a second Quillforge. |
| Show in folder | Opens Explorer with the file selected. |

If you close a document with unsaved changes, Quillforge asks whether to save them.

### Images and links

Relative paths work as on GitHub: `![diagram](img/diagram.png)` shows the image stored next to the .md file. In GitHub preview, links to web pages open in your browser, links to other `.md` files open in Quillforge, and `#heading` links jump inside the document.

## 7. Export and print

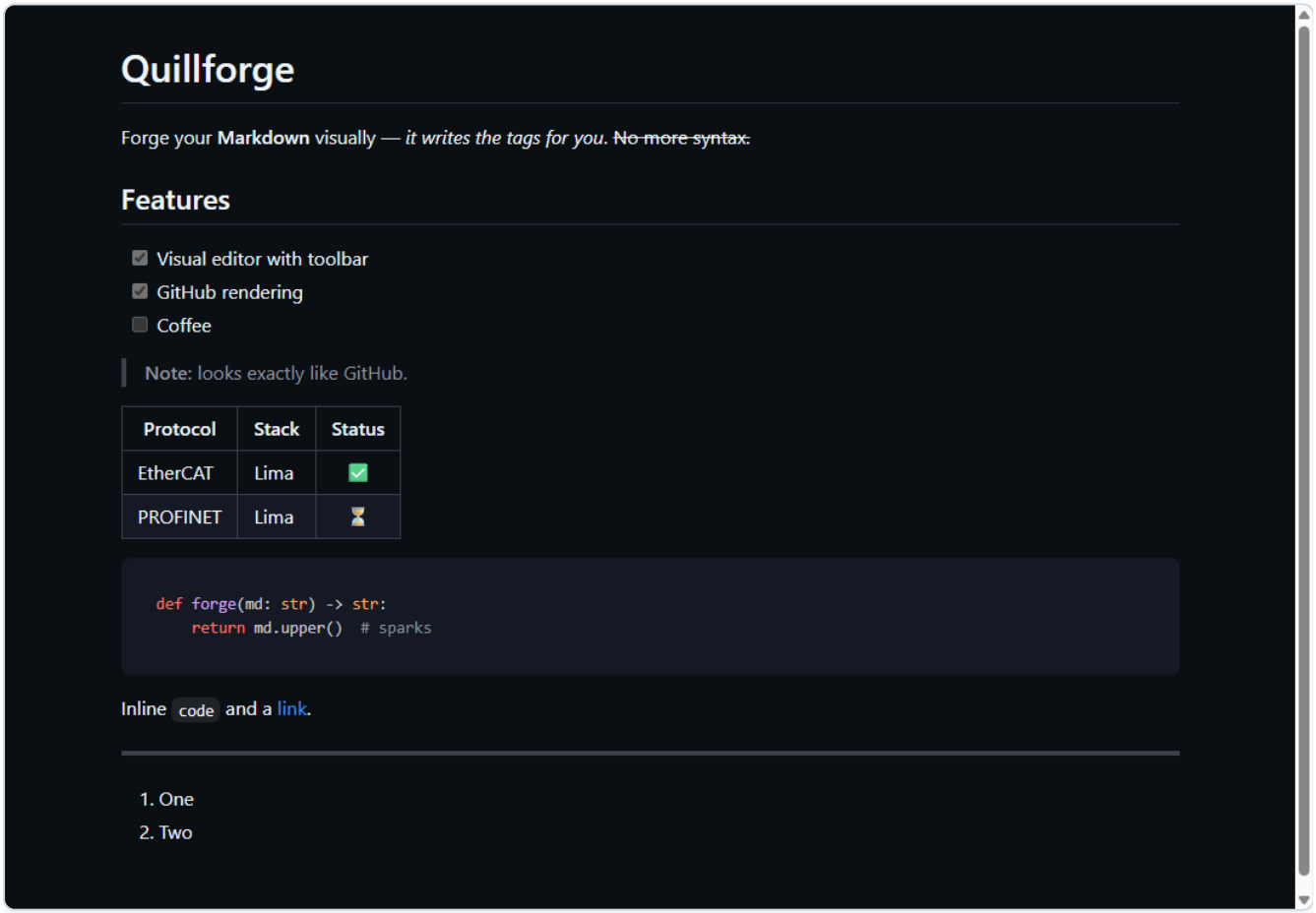
**Export to HTML** saves a single, self-contained HTML page with the GitHub style embedded — ready to e-mail or publish.

**Print / PDF** (`Ctrl`+`P`) prints the GitHub-style page. Choose *Save as PDF* as the printer to create a PDF.

## 8. Language, theme and zoom

**Language** menu: English or Español. It changes the menus, the toolbar tooltips and dialogs immediately. The first time, Quillforge follows the Windows language.

**View → Dark theme** switches between GitHub light and GitHub dark. Zoom with `Ctrl`+`+`, `Ctrl`+`-` and `Ctrl`+`0`. Language, theme, mode, zoom and window size are remembered.




GitHub dark theme.

## 9. Keyboard shortcuts

| Keys | Action | Keys | Action |
|---|---|---|---|
| `Ctrl` + `N` | New | `Ctrl` + `B` | Bold |
| `Ctrl` + `O` | Open | `Ctrl` + `I` | Italic |
| `Ctrl` + `S` | Save | `Ctrl` + `Z` / `Ctrl` + `Y` | Undo / Redo |
| `Ctrl` + `Shift` + `S` | Save as | `Ctrl` + `1` / `2` / `3` | Visual / Source / GitHub |
| `Ctrl` + `P` | Print / PDF | `Ctrl` + `+` / `-` / `0` | Zoom |
| `Ctrl` + `W` | Close window | `F1` | This manual |

## 10. Technical information

| Item | Detail |
|---|---|
| Version | 1.0.0 |
| Platform | .NET 8 (WPF, self-contained) + Microsoft Edge WebView2 |
| Editor | TOAST UI Editor 3.2 (MIT) |
| GitHub rendering | marked (GitHub Flavored Markdown), highlight.js, github-markdown-css (MIT) |
| Icon | Griffin from Martin Schongauer's engraving (c. 1485), The Metropolitan Museum of Art, CC0; quill added. |
| Settings | `%APPDATA%\Quillforge\settings.json` |
| Source code | `src/` in the project folder; build with `build.ps1`. |

> The visual editor normalises some details when it writes Markdown (for example, `*` lists become `-`). The text and the way GitHub displays it do not change.